their enclaves. Madhav Sadashiv Gore (1921–2010), an eminent sociologist, noted many of these issues in a book called *Immigrants and Neighbourhoods* in 1970, which studied the Marathi-, Hindi-and Tamil-speaking groups of Bombay. Writing about the most cosmopolitan city of India and the city of my birth, he observed that:[61]

> The path of migration is cleared and smoothened by friends and relatives. When our rural migrant moves from his home into Bombay he need not experience the loneliness and uncertainty or even the anonymity of the big metropolis. He is only moving from the residential family unit to the extended family outpost in the city. This explains why the 'nearest' town or city is not always a preferred option.

Gore also studied friendships in the city and found that Brahmins were more likely to make friends belonging to their own caste than non-Brahmins across all three linguistic groups, with an extremely strong preference noted for the Tamilians.[62] In neighbourhoods, language was an important factor for developing acquaintances, even more than religion, and one third of the housewives in the sample reported no acquaintance of any kind outside the immediate family.

Since 1970, more immigrants from north India arrived in Mumbai, and Hindi emerged as the language to bind the masses, even more than Marathi which is spoken by roughly 40 per cent of the city's population. 'South Indians' make up around 10 per cent of Mumbai's population today while a fifth of the population speaks Gujarati. It has retained its multi-lingual character, and the enclaves and social exclusions described by Gore have weakened only partially through greater inter-linguistic marriage. Having married outside my linguistic group, just like my parents did much earlier, I am now party to bewildering household practices, super-spicy food, and tuned to learning aspects of Mumbai such as the social differences along the Western and Central Railways lines, something I could not have known earlier.

Each linguistic diaspora has its own style of celebrating religious festivals, cuisines and distinct music and dance classes attended by children. The spread of Ganesh Utsav celebrations is linked with the spread